

Problem 3

Part a)

Calculation of Marginal Distributions: We first determine the marginal densities $f_X(x)$ and $f_Y(y)$ using the joint density.

$$\begin{aligned} f_X(x) &= \int_{\mathbb{R}} f_{(X,Y)}(x, y) dy \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{1}{4}(1 + xy)\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]^2}(x, y) dy \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{1}{4}(1 + xy)\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x)\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(y) dy \\ &= \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x) \int_{-1}^1 (1 + xy) dy \\ &= \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x) \left[y + x\frac{y^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^1 \\ &= \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x) \left(\left(1 + \frac{x}{2}\right) - \left(-1 + \frac{x}{2}\right) \right) \\ &= \frac{1}{4}(2)\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x) \\ &= \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x) \end{aligned}$$

By symmetry of the joint density function, the marginal density of Y is identical:

$$f_Y(y) = \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(y)$$

Thus, X and Y are both uniformly distributed on $[-1, 1]$, i.e., $X, Y \sim \mathcal{U}(-1, 1)$.

Part a) i)

- **Calculation of $\mathbb{E}[X\mathbf{1}_{\{X < 1/2\}}]$:** Since $|X\mathbf{1}_{\{X < 1/2\}}| \leq 1$, the random variable is bounded and thus its expectation exists. Using the marginal density $f_X(x) = \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x)$ and Corollary 3.3.13.:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[X\mathbf{1}_{\{X < 1/2\}}] &= \int_{\mathbb{R}} x\mathbf{1}_{(-\infty, 1/2)}(x)f_X(x) dx \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}} x\mathbf{1}_{(-\infty, 1/2)}(x)\frac{1}{2}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x) dx \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{x}{2}\mathbf{1}_{[-1, \frac{1}{2})}(x) dx \\ &= \int_{-1}^{1/2} \frac{x}{2} dx \\ &= \left[\frac{x^2}{4} \right]_{-1}^{1/2} = \left(\frac{1}{16} - \frac{1}{4} \right) = \frac{1}{16} - \frac{4}{16} = -\frac{3}{16} \end{aligned}$$

- **Calculation of $\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{1}{X}\right]$:** Using the marginal density $f_X(x) = \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]}(x)$ and the substitution formula (Corollary 3.3.13), the expectation is given by the integral:

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{1}{X}\right] = \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{1}{x}f_X(x) dx = \int_{-1}^1 \frac{1}{2x} dx$$

This is an improper integral due to the singularity at $x = 0$. Let $Z = \frac{1}{X}$. According to Definition 3.3.7, for the expected value to exist, we must check the integrability of the positive part $Z^+ = \max(0, Z)$ and the negative part $Z^- = -\min(0, Z)$.

Evaluating the expectation of the positive part:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[Z^+] &= \int_0^1 \frac{1}{2x} dx \\ &= \lim_{\epsilon \searrow 0} \left[\frac{1}{2} \ln(x) \right]_{\epsilon}^1 \\ &= \lim_{\epsilon \searrow 0} \left(0 - \frac{1}{2} \ln(\epsilon) \right) = \infty\end{aligned}$$

Evaluating the expectation of the negative part:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[Z^-] &= \int_{-1}^0 \left(-\frac{1}{2x} \right) dx \\ &= \lim_{\epsilon \nearrow 0} \left[-\frac{1}{2} \ln|x| \right]_{-1}^{\epsilon} \\ &= \lim_{\epsilon \nearrow 0} \left(-\frac{1}{2} \ln|\epsilon| - 0 \right) = \infty\end{aligned}$$

Since $\mathbb{E}[Z^+] = \mathbb{E}[Z^-] = \infty$, the expected value $\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{1}{X}\right]$ **does not exist** (Definition 3.3.7(iii)).

- **Calculation of $\mathbb{E}[XY]$:**

Using the joint density and the substitution formula in $\mathbb{R}^2$ (Theorem 3.3.12):

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[XY] &= \int_{\mathbb{R}^2} xy \cdot f_{(X,Y)}(x, y) d\lambda^2(x, y) \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}^2} xy \cdot \frac{1}{4}(1 + xy)\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]^2}(x, y) d\lambda^2(x, y)\end{aligned}$$

Since $|xy| \leq 1$ on the support $[-1, 1]^2$, we have $\mathbb{E}[|XY|] \leq 1 < \infty$. Thus, Fubini's theorem applies and we can arbitrarily choose the order of integration:

$$\begin{aligned}&= \int_{\mathbb{R}} \int_{\mathbb{R}} xy \cdot \frac{1}{4}(1 + xy)\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]^2}(x, y) dy dx \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \int_{-1}^1 \int_{-1}^1 (xy + x^2 y^2) dy dx \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \int_{-1}^1 x \left[\frac{y^2}{2} \right]_{-1}^1 + x^2 \left[\frac{y^3}{3} \right]_{-1}^1 dx \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \int_{-1}^1 \left(x \left(\frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2} \right) + x^2 \left(\frac{1}{3} - \left(-\frac{1}{3} \right) \right) \right) dx \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \int_{-1}^1 \left(0 + x^2 \left(\frac{2}{3} \right) \right) dx \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \int_{-1}^1 \frac{2x^2}{3} dx = \frac{1}{6} \int_{-1}^1 x^2 dx \\ &= \frac{1}{6} \left[\frac{x^3}{3} \right]_{-1}^1 = \frac{1}{6} \left(\frac{1}{3} - \left(-\frac{1}{3} \right) \right) = \frac{1}{6} \left(\frac{2}{3} \right) = \frac{2}{18} = \frac{1}{9}\end{aligned}$$

Part a) ii)

According to Theorem 3.2.3 c), the continuous random variables X and Y are independent if and only if $f_{(X,Y)}(x,y) = f_X(x)f_Y(y)$ for Lebesgue-almost all $(x,y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$. The product of the marginals is:

$$f_X(x)f_Y(y) = \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]^2}(x,y).$$

Since $\frac{1}{4}\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]^2}(x,y) \neq \frac{1}{4}(1+xy)\mathbf{1}_{[-1,1]^2}(x,y)$ on a set of non-zero Lebesgue measure (specifically, the regions where $xy \neq 0$), X and Y are not independent.

Part b)

We apply the Law of Total Probability (Theorem 2.1.7) to the countable partition $\{Y = k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}_0}$:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}(X > Y) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \mathbb{P}(X > Y \mid Y = k)\mathbb{P}(Y = k) \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \mathbb{P}(X > k \mid Y = k)\mathbb{P}(Y = k).\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

By Definition 3.2.1, X and Y are independent, meaning $\mathbb{P}(X \in A, Y \in B) = \mathbb{P}(X \in A)\mathbb{P}(Y \in B)$. We use the definition of conditional probability to simplify the conditional term:

$$\mathbb{P}(X > k \mid Y = k) = \frac{\mathbb{P}(X > k, Y = k)}{\mathbb{P}(Y = k)} = \frac{\mathbb{P}(X > k)\mathbb{P}(Y = k)}{\mathbb{P}(Y = k)} = \mathbb{P}(X > k).$$

Substituting this back into (1) and using the probability mass function for $Y \sim \text{Geom}(p)$ gives:

$$\mathbb{P}(X > Y) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \mathbb{P}(X > k)p(1-p)^k.\tag{2}$$

To evaluate $\mathbb{P}(X > k)$, we integrate the density of $X \sim \text{Exp}(\lambda)$. Because the outer sum iterates over $Y \sim \text{Geom}(p)$ where $k \in \mathbb{N}_0$, we know $k \geq 0$. Thus, the indicator function is 1 over the entire interval $[k, \infty)$:

$$\mathbb{P}(X > k) = \int_k^{\infty} \lambda e^{-\lambda x} \mathbf{1}_{[0,\infty)}(x) dx = \int_k^{\infty} \lambda e^{-\lambda x} dx.$$

Substituting $u = -\lambda x$, so $du = -\lambda dx$, with bounds $x = k \Rightarrow u = -\lambda k$ and $x \rightarrow \infty \Rightarrow u \rightarrow -\infty$:

$$\mathbb{P}(X > k) = \int_{-\lambda k}^{-\infty} (-1)e^u du = \int_{-\infty}^{-\lambda k} e^u du = [e^u]_{-\infty}^{-\lambda k} = e^{-\lambda k} - \lim_{a \rightarrow -\infty} e^a = e^{-\lambda k}.$$

Substituting this result back into (2) yields:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}(X > Y) &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} e^{-\lambda k} \cdot p(1-p)^k \\ &= p \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(e^{-\lambda}(1-p)\right)^k.\end{aligned}$$

Since $\lambda > 0$ implies $0 < e^{-\lambda} < 1$ and $p \in (0, 1)$ implies $0 < (1-p) < 1$, we have $q := e^{-\lambda}(1-p) \in (0, 1)$, so we can apply the geometric series formula $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} q^k = \frac{1}{1-q}$:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}(X > Y) &= p \left(\frac{1}{1 - e^{-\lambda}(1-p)} \right) \\ &= \frac{p}{1 - e^{-\lambda}(1-p)}.\end{aligned}$$